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Reflection Period: May 25, 2022 - May 29, 2024

Connects provide a regular touchpoint where you and your manager can come together with a growth mindset to reflect on impact and discuss areas for improvement and future development.

Fixed Mindset leads to a desire to look smart and therefore a tendency to avoid challenges, give up easily, see failures as fruitless or worse, ignore useful negative feedback and feel threatened by the success of others.

Growth Mindset leads to a desire to learn and therefore a tendency to embrace challenges, persist in the face of setback, see failures as essential to mastery, learn from criticism and find lessons and inspiration in the success of others.

Reflect on the past

One aspect of successful impact is when you consistently deliver against all and likely exceed some expectations for your core priorities. Capture what you've accomplished and learned since your last Connect.

Summarize your impact

Core priorities

What impact did you have for each of your core priorities?

> Delivered the initial pipeline and plumbing for both in-app sidecar chat and out-of-app M365 copilot scenarios for F&O. Working closely across the F&O arch group as well as PowerPlatform/Dataverse/PowerApps/MCS teams to deliver aligned experiences and unblock both

internal app teams and external customers. The in-app copilot chat supporting DocQnA has just gone GA. At //build, multiple partners are demoing experiences built on F&O utilizing MCS and the rest of the plumbing. I provided the initial implementation of the majority of the plumbing, including pulling the sidecar chat control from PPUX into the client, wiring up to MCS, writing the auth shims, creating the MAU tracking telemetry, etc. I also created the ability to expose F&O logic as CustomAPI in Dataverse, which allows it to play in all the downstream scenarios including MCS and other AI areas. As F&O now has an official Nexus team that owns this area, I have worked closely to onboard that team to all the tech, as well as continuing to work closely with them to move the features forward.

Customers (a few recent examples):

- Bossard - Still noisy
- Deere - Suggestion on Field Service + Licensing explanation, helped David and Harsh on the proposed Field Service / Account alignment issue.
- RDO - Told Mark to feel free to ping me and Eric and we're happy to review stuff.
- Agrico/Cegeka - Upset at how hard it was for us to restart things, problem was their code. Basically we dropped the ball a few times, so they’re extra sensitive and I’m hand-holding a few things to get them happy again.
- CZAV/Cegeka - Repeated crashes, trouble communicating with support. Helped runtime team track it down to a customization that Cegeka is looking into.
- Komatsu - RecId indexes fixed (also one other customer), still suspicious of any blip in perf. Appears their German site may have networking issues, helping them with guidance on debugging.
- Velosio - Standard CSS playbook, either bouncing tickets or they go dark for a week on simple bugs till they get upset, Rob Urbanowicz pings me, I ping the ticket to get it moving again.
- USABlueBook – Diagnosed memory issues, discovered forms were never being closed which was globally fixed.
- Amdocs – Assisting on patterns related to Virtual Entity and other extension scenarios in the DV platform.
- MattressFirm – Helped discover and fix tens of millions of duplicate credit card auth records which was brining down their system.
- Variety of Customers - Business events was completely broken by race condition as well as casting error in Power Automate. PA team keeps dropping the ball, so I keep bugging them to do the next step. Mostly fixed now.

Other:

- Investigation and planning related to date effectivity.
- Delivered example and roadmap for getting PowerFx into the F&O platform.
- Export control GA’d in 10.0.39, continuing to help Kongsberg and other customers.
- Assisting with continued roll out of Unified Dev Environments (aka Uno Dev).
- Continued consulting and helping teams with historical knowledge of systems and debugging.

Diversity & Inclusion (D&I) Core Priority

What impact did your actions have in contributing to a more diverse and inclusive Microsoft?

> My focus here is mostly in ensuring the various voices from the various teams I'm working on are heard and considered appropriately. With all teams being so overloaded and the loudest voices often winning, trying to get the various members of teams to understand where the other team is coming from and why they're pushing for something can be a challenge.

Manager comments

Jeff continued to show his consistently excellent capabilities resolving complex escalations. Perhaps as much as his technical ability, Jeff always demonstrates an unwillingness to let something go until it is resolved. There were -- as always -- multiple examples where Jeff stayed with an issue that others would have dropped. Specifically, he resolved a memory issue at USABluebook that nobody else wanted to pursue, leading to a significant memory savings across the entire fleet. At MattressFirm, he identified and resolved an issue that others abandoned in their credit card table leading to a material reduction in their overall database size -- critical as storage enforcement looms. At Bossard, the fight continues, but Jeff is responsible for getting this escalation related to AZ latency to a manageable level. In every case, Jeff not only solves the issue but helps make the product, the partner and the customer better. This ability to teach while doing delivers real impact.

Jeff's ability to singlehandedly deliver development contributions is extraordinary. He continues to steward his Export Control feature as usage grows, but most importantly in this period, Jeff delivered the core enablement for Copilot support withing FnO. He fills the role of a missing application platform team -- and does it exceptionally well.

Jeff also provides guidance in key prospect situations -- including most recently John Deere and RDO. He is the best resource to guide around the use of our integration technologies -- specifically Virtual Entity, Dual Write and Business Events.

Jeff also has the judgement to know when not to do something. Most recently, Jeff did great work identifying a strategy to make the FnO Date Effectivity support materially more performant, but also identified that this would not be the right time to target this work.

In the coming period, I look forward to great results around the Dataverse Scale Unit.

Reflect on a challenge or setback

In addition to your accomplishments relative to your core priorities, you must demonstrate a growth mindset to deliver successful impact. Share how you demonstrated a growth mindset by taking personal accountability for setbacks, asking for feedback, and applying learnings to have greater impact.

Consider when you could have done something differently. How will you apply what you learned to make an even greater impact?

> There were some miscommunications in the Dataverse runtime PM team which led to F&O not showing up in the official //build tracking spreadsheets. Two PM's each thought the other was covering it, so no one was. This led to increased friction in trying to get attention on high priority bug fixes and conversations. In hindsight I should have more closely tracked the PM-side communication to catch misalignment issues like this earlier. To avoid this type of issue going forward, I am investing more time personally engaging in PM conversations across the DV PM organization to ensure everyone is aware and on the same page.

Manager comments

As always, Jeff is taking responsibility for challenges that exist elsewhere -- not his own. THANK YOU.

Plan for the future

Think about opportunities for impact in the upcoming Connect period. What are your 3-5 core priorities?

Review your core priorities

Core priorities

1. **Copilot / AI**

   Focus areas for the upcoming period to drive business impact:
   - Deliver Generative Actions for the F&O bot using X++ exposed as CustomAPI. (Target: Late summer)
   - Engage on agentic work to enable Maven/MCS agents to access the breadth of the application. (Target: Late summer / fall)
   - Continue improving the at-scale dev experience for 1P and 3P. (Ongoing)

   Success measures:
   Release, MAU, Partner Impact

2. **Customer Engagements**

   Focus areas for the upcoming period to drive business impact:
   Ongoing / as they arise

   Success measures:
   Customer escalations and success

3. **RCSU on Dataverse**

Focus areas for the upcoming period to drive business impact:
Begin investigation on migrating RCSU to Dataverse, help build roadmap for getting on standard DV for RCSU.

Success measures:
Delivery of a path forward, plan in place for future semester

4. **Consulting with Engineering Teams**

Focus areas for the upcoming period to drive business impact:
Ongoing consults on topics as they arise.

Success measures:
Customer satisfaction and descalation

Diversity & Inclusion (D&I) Core Priority

To realize our mission to empower every person and organization on the planet to achieve more, each and every one of us must help create a diverse and inclusive culture where everyone can bring their full and authentic self, in alignment with our values. Consider how you will **deliver successful impact by consistently demonstrating Microsoft's cultural expectations and values**. Visit the Diversity & Inclusion (D&I) Core Priority page for guidance and examples of impact.

Select and commit to at least one focus area from the options below, or create one of your own.

Seek diverse perspectives and incorporate feedback, apply insights from a variety of sources and people

How will you define success as you activate your D&I Core Priority?

Diverse viewpoints of diverse teams considered and understood in cross-team collaborations.

Manager comments

Fully aligned. The Scale Unit on Dataverse will be a huge win for BAP.

Identify your opportunities for growth

We are all expected to embrace a growth mindset and focus on continuous learning to deliver successful impact.

What 1-2 actions will you take to focus on learning, growth, and development over the next period?

I believe most of my learning and growth will come around agent scenarios and LLM's. No one is sure exactly how "smart" an LLM can be and how much we can trust them to make decisions. Helping the team to make the decisions on how much power to give agents will involve significant research and investigation. Both personally, as well as continuing to track what others in industry are succeeding with. I expect this to be a combination of personal projects, reading research papers, tracking public projects, and learning from other engineers.

What support do you need to fulfill these actions? Fill in any that apply.

Opportunities to (optional):

> No Response

Perspective or coaching on (optional):

> No Response

Learning on (optional):

> No Response

Manager comments

100% -- Jeff's growth here -- understanding agents along with all of us -- will deliver impact for Jeff, BAP and Microsoft.

Conversation starters (optional)

Choose any of these optional prompts to continue great conversations with your manager. Write a brief response (1-15 words).

Of my strengths, the ones I'd like to apply more in my work are:

In my work, I feel motivated or energized by:

In my work, I lose motivation or energy from:

I know I can't do everything on my own. I'd like help with:

It can be challenging to prioritize important topics for 1:1 conversations. Plan ahead and flag any of the following topics you'd like to discuss with your manager in upcoming conversations.

Career: Discuss ways to grow my career to align with my strengths, interest & aspirations.

Recognition: Discuss my recognition preferences and highlight my contributions.

Opportunities: Increase my responsibilities, such as new core priorities, stretch assignments, promotion or becoming a people manager.

Alignment: Clarify priorities and expectations for successful impact.

Learning: Explore potential development and growth opportunities to optimize your performance.

Feedback: Get input on how I'm doing in my role and how to deliver great impact.

Flexibility: Consider how you work best and discuss your workplace preferences (i.e. site, location, hours)

Wellbeing: Discuss any dimensions of being well: mental, emotional, physical, financial.

Check out aka.ms/career for resources and guides on developing your career.

Manager comments